

PUBLIC GOOD

Kinara

Drowning prevention

Crèches plus survival-swim training are proven, cheap, evidence-backed child-drowning prevention



THE SITUATION IN BANGLADESH

In Bangladesh drowning is the leading cause of death among children aged 1–4 years, killing roughly 40 children every day ¹. The country has one of the world's highest drowning rates, with most deaths during the unsupervised mid-morning hours when caregivers are working ⁷. This burden is part of a global crisis: WHO estimates ~300,000 drowning deaths worldwide each year, a quarter of them children under 5, with 92% concentrated in low- and middle-income countries like Bangladesh ⁵. Yet most of these deaths go unrecorded and unaddressed, even though local, low-cost prevention measures already exist ¹.

OUR PITCH

Kinara closes the supervision gap with two evidence-backed interventions: community crèches (Anchal) that keep 1–4 year-olds safe during peak-risk daytime hours, and SwimSafe survival-swim training for older children. The crèche model is proven — in the large-scale SoLiD cohort study, drowning deaths fell by 88% among enrolled children aged 1–4 ⁶, RNLI/CIPRB report a free crèche place cuts a child's drowning risk by 82% ⁷, and SwimSafe was evaluated as 96% protective against drowning ³. It is also remarkably cheap, at roughly US\$16 per child per year and an ICER of about US\$17,008 per life saved ², and is exactly the package WHO's 2021 guideline recommends — day-care plus basic swimming and water-safety skills ⁴. Kinara is impact-first and funder-funded by design, riding a proven wave of catalytic capital — Bloomberg Philanthropies committed an additional US\$60 million in 2024 (US\$104 million total globally) for drowning prevention including Bangladesh ⁸ — so results-based grants, not user fees, pay for saving children's lives.

SOURCES (8)

1. Centre for Injury Prevention and Research, Bangladesh (CIPRB) (2024). Drowning Prevention. www.ciprb.org/drowning-prevention...
2. Sarker, A.R. et al. (2021). Cost-effectiveness of a large-scale crèche intervention to prevent child drowning in rural Bangladesh. *Injury Epidemiology* 8:51. injejournal.biomedcentral.com/articles/1...
3. SwimSafe programme evaluation (96% protective). en.wikipedia.org/wiki/SwimSafe...
4. World Health Organization (2021). Guideline on prevention of drowning through day-care and basic swimming/water-safety skills. [www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/books/NBK572790/...](https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/books/NBK572790/)
5. World Health Organization (2024). Global status report on drowning prevention 2024. www.who.int/publications/i/item/9789240103...
6. Rahman, A. et al. / JH-IIRU (2020). Large-scale evaluation of interventions to reduce childhood drownings in rural Bangladesh (SoLiD). *Injury Epidemiology* 7:21. injejournal.biomedcentral.com/articles/1...
7. Royal National Lifeboat Institution (2023). Crèches for Bangladesh. rnli.org/what-we-do/international/lifesavi...
8. World Health Organization (2024). Drowning deaths decline globally but the most vulnerable remain at risk (13 Dec 2024). www.who.int/news/item/13-12-2024-drowning-...